

Prednisone

(Prednisone Intensol, Sterapred, Deltasone)

I. Classification

- Corticosteroid

II. Actions

- Suppresses polymorphonuclear leukocytes and reverses capillary permeability to decrease inflammation
- Suppresses immune system
- Suppresses adrenal function at high doses

III. Indications

- Allergic reaction / Anaphylaxis
- Asthma / COPD

IV. Contraindications

- Known Hypersensitivity
- Systemic fungal infections
- Recent live vaccinations

V. Precautions

- Caution in patients with active infections (bacterial, viral)
- Caution in patients with recent live viral vaccinations
- Caution in immunosuppressed patients
- Caution in ocular infections (especially herpes simplex infections)
- Caution in hyperglycemia and diabetes – worsens hyperglycemia
- Caution in CHF

VI. Drug Interactions

- Live viral vaccines

VII. Adult dosing and administration

- 60 mg PO x1

VIII. Pediatric dosing and administration:

- 1 mg/kg PO (max dose 60 mg)

IX. Onset

- 2-4 hours

X. Duration

- 18-36 hours

XI. Possible adverse effects

- Anaphylaxis
- Headache / Vertigo / Insomnia / Nervousness / Mood swings
- Hyperglycemia
- Hypertension
- Seizures